

senseUS — Project Scaffolding Guide

Stack: React + Vite · Supabase · Vercel · Twilio Verify · i18next

Audience: Non-technical founder working with a technical collaborator

Goal: Get from zero to a running local dev environment with the correct folder structure, dependencies, and first deployable shell

Prerequisites

Before starting, confirm these are installed and working:

Tool	Check	Install if missing
Node.js (v18+)	<code>node -v</code> in terminal	https://nodejs.org
npm	<code>npm -v</code>	Comes with Node
Git	<code>git --version</code>	https://git-scm.com
VS Code	Open and running	https://code.visualstudio.com

You'll also need accounts (free tiers work for launch):

- **Supabase** — <https://supabase.com>
 - **Vercel** — <https://vercel.com>
 - **Twilio** — <https://twilio.com> (for Verify)
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Phase 1 — Create the Project

Open VS Code. Open the integrated terminal (`Ctrl+`` or `⌘+`` on Mac).

1.1 Scaffold with Vite

```
bash

npm create vite@latest senseus -- --template react
cd senseus
npm install
```

This creates a React + Vite project called `senseus` and installs base dependencies.

1.2 Run the dev server to confirm it works

```
bash  
  
npm run dev
```

Visit `http://localhost:5173` — you should see the default Vite + React page. Press `Ctrl+C` to stop.

Phase 2 — Install Core Dependencies

```
bash  
  
npm install @supabase/supabase-js  
npm install react-router-dom  
npm install i18next react-i18next i18next-browser-languagedetector  
npm install react-hook-form  
npm install --save-dev tailwindcss postcss autoprefixer  
npx tailwindcss init -p
```

What each does:

- `@supabase/supabase-js` — database, auth, and storage client
 - `react-router-dom` — page routing (home, vote, profile, admin)
 - `i18next` + plugins — internationalization; set up in English now, add Spanish/Portuguese later
 - `react-hook-form` — form handling for registration, question submission
 - `tailwindcss` — utility-first CSS; matches the rapid iteration style of the project
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Phase 3 — Configure Tailwind

Open `tailwind.config.js` and replace its contents:

```
js
```

```
/** @type {import('tailwindcss').Config} */
export default {
  content: [
    './index.html',
    './src/**/*..{js,ts,jsx,tsx}',
  ],
  theme: {
    extend: {
      colors: {
        indigo: {
          brand: '#2D3DCA',
        },
        green: {
          brand: '#52B788',
        },
      },
    },
  },
  plugins: [],
}
```

Open `src/index.css` and replace its contents:

```
css

@tailwind base;
@tailwind components;
@tailwind utilities;
```

Phase 4 — Folder Structure

Delete everything inside `src/` and recreate it with this structure:

```

senseus/
├─ public/
│   └─ logo.svg           ← drop your SVG logo here
├─ src/
│   ├─ assets/            ← images, icons
│   ├─ components/        ← reusable UI pieces
│   │   ├─ ui/            ← buttons, inputs, modals
│   │   ├─ vote/          ← thumb voting widget
│   │   └─ layout/        ← header, footer, nav
│   ├─ pages/             ← one file per route
│   │   ├─ Home.jsx
│   │   ├─ Vote.jsx
│   │   ├─ Profile.jsx
│   │   ├─ Register.jsx
│   │   └─ Admin.jsx
│   ├─ lib/
│   │   ├─ supabase.js    ← Supabase client init
│   │   └─ i18n.js        ← i18next config
│   ├─ hooks/             ← custom React hooks
│   ├─ context/           ← React context (auth state, etc.)
│   ├─ utils/             ← helper functions
│   ├─ locales/
│   │   └─ en/
│   │       └─ translation.json ← English strings
│   ├─ App.jsx
│   └─ main.jsx
├─ .env.local              ← secrets (never commit this)
├─ .gitignore
├─ index.html
├─ vite.config.js
└─ package.json

```

Create the folders in terminal:

```

bash

mkdir -p src/{assets,components/{ui,vote,layout},pages,lib,hooks,context,utils,

```

Phase 5 — Environment Variables

Create `.env.local` in the project root (this file must never be committed to Git):

```
VITE_SUPABASE_URL=your_supabase_project_url
VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=your_supabase_anon_key
VITE_TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID=your_twilio_account_sid
VITE_TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN=your_twilio_auth_token
VITE_TWILIO_VERIFY_SID=your_twilio_verify_service_sid
```

Note: In Vite, environment variables must start with `VITE_` to be accessible in the browser. Values are injected at build time — never put truly secret server-side keys here. Twilio calls will eventually route through Supabase Edge Functions, not the browser directly.

Confirm `.gitignore` already includes `.env.local` (Vite's default does).

Phase 6 — Wire Up Supabase

Create `src/lib/supabase.js`:

```
js

import { createClient } from '@supabase/supabase-js'

const supabaseUrl = import.meta.env.VITE_SUPABASE_URL
const supabaseAnonKey = import.meta.env.VITE_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY

export const supabase = createClient(supabaseUrl, supabaseAnonKey)
```

This exports a single shared client used everywhere in the app.

Phase 7 — Wire Up i18next

Create `src/lib/i18n.js`:

```
js
```

```

import i18n from 'i18next'
import { initReactI18next } from 'react-i18next'
import LanguageDetector from 'i18next-browser-languagedetector'

i18n
  .use(LanguageDetector)
  .use(initReactI18next)
  .init({
    fallbackLng: 'en',
    debug: false,
    resources: {
      en: {
        translation: require('../locales/en/translation.json')
      }
    },
    interpolation: {
      escapeValue: false
    }
  })

export default i18n

```

Create `src/locales/en/translation.json` with a starter entry:

```

json
{
  "app_name": "senseUS",
  "tagline": "Real people. Real opinions.",
  "nav": {
    "home": "Home",
    "vote": "Vote",
    "profile": "Profile"
  }
}

```

Phase 8 — App Shell

Replace `src/main.jsx`:

```

jsx

```

```

import React from 'react'
import ReactDOM from 'react-dom/client'
import App from './App.jsx'
import './index.css'
import './lib/i18n'

ReactDOM.createRoot(document.getElementById('root')).render(
  <React.StrictMode>
    <App />
  </React.StrictMode>,
)

```

Replace `src/App.jsx`:

```

jsx

import { BrowserRouter, Routes, Route } from 'react-router-dom'
import Home from './pages/Home'
import Vote from './pages/Vote'
import Profile from './pages/Profile'
import Register from './pages/Register'

function App() {
  return (
    <BrowserRouter>
      <Routes>
        <Route path="/" element={<Home />} />
        <Route path="/vote" element={<Vote />} />
        <Route path="/profile" element={<Profile />} />
        <Route path="/register" element={<Register />} />
      </Routes>
    </BrowserRouter>
  )
}

export default App

```

Create a stub for each page (repeat pattern for Vote, Profile, Register):

`src/pages/Home.jsx`:

```

jsx

```

```
export default function Home() {  
  return <div className="p-8 text-2xl font-bold text-indigo-700">senseUS - Home  
}
```

Phase 9 — Git Init and First Commit

```
bash  
  
git init  
git add .  
git commit -m "Initial scaffold: React + Vite, Supabase, i18next, Tailwind"
```

Phase 10 — Deploy to Vercel

10.1 Push to GitHub first

Create a new (private) repo on GitHub. Then:

```
bash  
  
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/senseus.git  
git branch -M main  
git push -u origin main
```

10.2 Connect to Vercel

1. Go to <https://vercel.com/new>
2. Import your GitHub repo
3. Framework preset: **Vite** (auto-detected)
4. Add your environment variables (same as `.env.local`) under **Environment Variables**
5. Click **Deploy**

Vercel will give you a live URL immediately. Every `git push` to `main` auto-deploys.

What You Have After This

Layer	Status
React + Vite dev environment	✓ Running locally
Routing (4 page stubs)	✓ Wired
Tailwind with senseUS brand colors	✓ Configured
Supabase client	✓ Connected (needs project URL/key)
i18next (English)	✓ Ready for content
Environment variables	✓ Structured securely
Git repo	✓ Version controlled
Vercel deployment	✓ Live URL

What Comes Next (Build Order)

1. **Supabase schema** — users, questions, votes, integrity_scores tables
 2. **Auth flow** — phone verification via Twilio Verify, 18+ gate, display name selection
 3. **Vote widget** — the five-option thumb component with color coding
 4. **Question feed** — home page with active questions
 5. **Profile page** — vote history, display name management
 6. **Admin panel** — question moderation, sponsored question queue
 7. **Integrity scoring** — passive weighting logic in Supabase functions
 8. **Transparency report data** — aggregate query layer for biannual reports
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